The 'Ek Ped Maa Ke Naam' campaign witnessed a remarkable demonstration of public resolve in Uttar Pradesh, where over 35 crores saplings were planted in a single day on July 12. As a Member of Parliament representing Uttar Pradesh, this achievement fills me with immense pride."

Narendra Modi
Prime Minister



around 2,000 nurseries managed by the Forest Department. These saplings are now being distributed in a phased manner to ensure their timely availability to all departments and local bodies. This year, the Ganga Expressway will receive special focus. Around 5.50 lakh saplings are being planted across 500 hectares along both sides of the approximately 594-kilometre expressway. Every kilometre will feature the Harishankari trees, while ecologically significant native species such as Peepal, Pakad, Banyan, Neem, Gular, Mahua, Mango, Arjun, Chilbil, Amaltas, Kachnar, Jacaranda and Gulmohar will be given priority. The Government has gone beyond plantation by putting in place comprehensive measures for the protection of the saplings. Fencing will be installed to safeguard them, while modern irrigation systems such as drip irrigation will be developed to ensure their sustained growth.

Wetland Conservation and Schools Join the Green Movement

The Yogi Government has not limited its environmental conservation policy to plantation alone. Significant progress is also being made in the conservation and scientific management of the state's wetlands. Under the Wetlands (Conservation and Management) Rules, 2017, the process of identifying, demarcating and notifying wetlands is progressing rapidly across the state. So far, 101 wetlands spread across 26 districts have been officially notified, covering a total area of nearly 2,750 hectares. In addition, proposals for 44 new wetlands from 36 districts have been received by the Government. Demarcation has already been completed at 14,562 locations across all 75 districts to prevent encroachment and ensure their scientific conservation. The Government is also preparing documentation, maps and technical data in accordance with Ramsar Site criteria to secure international recognition for these wetlands. Schools, too, are being transformed into centres of environmental stewardship. The selection of 11 schools from Uttar Pradesh at the national level under the Government of India's 'Swachh Evam Harit Vidyalaya Rating (SHVR) 2025-26' is being regarded as a significant achievement. These include six Council schools, two Kasturba Gandhi Balika Vidyalayas, two schools from other categories, and one private school. Under 'Eco Clubs for Mission LiFE', a special calendar of activities has been rolled out for the month of July. The programme includes the 'Ek Ped Maa Ke Naam 3.0' campaign, nature walks, poster-making, essay writing, debates, slogan-writing, collage competitions, biodiversity studies and environmental awareness programmes. Most importantly, the responsibility for nurturing the planted saplings will also be entrusted to students, helping them develop a practical sense of responsibility towards nature conservation.



Building an Institutional Framework for Sustainability

To institutionalise environmental conservation, the State Government has sanctioned a financial outlay of nearly ₹65.64 crore for activities under 'Eco Clubs for Mission LiFE' as part of Samagra Shiksha for the financial year 2026-27. Every eligible Council-run primary, upper primary and composite school across the state will receive financial assistance of ₹5,000. Through these Eco Clubs, students will be engaged with the seven core themes of Mission LiFE, namely healthy and sustainable lifestyles, sustainable food systems, water conservation, energy conservation, waste management, e-waste management and reducing the use of single-use plastic. A comprehensive calendar of activities, to be implemented in phases from July to March, has also been prepared, making environmental education an integral part of the academic year. In another innovative initiative, the Social Welfare Department has decided to register every tree located within its schools, hostels and institutions as a government asset. Each tree will be assigned a unique identification number, and a digital record containing details such as its species, age, location and present condition will be maintained.